Host Mode

Self-serve subscription plan for Hostello PMS · 18 October 2026

> **Status:** plan only. Nothing is built. Decisions below are the owner's answers.

Plans and pricing

Plan	Listings	Notes
Starter	1–3	Rs 1,500–2,500 per month
Growth	4–10	Price to be set
Pro	11–30	Adds AI audits on request (run by the owner); price to be set

- Monthly or annual billing (about two months free on annual).
- 14-day free trial, no card. After a lapse: read-only for 14 days, then paused. Data is kept.
- Over the plan limit: hosts cannot add listings; nothing is deleted.

Key decisions

- **Market:** Pakistan first, PKR only; international later.
- **Same app and database.** A new account type *host* beside managed clients. Same Hostello brand, English only, one login per host.
- **Hosts keep 100%** of a booking's price. No Hostello split, Money pages, settlements or deal models. They do not see Channel inbox, Find dates or Rates tools.
- **Airbnb data:** iCal for dates (airbnb.com / booking.com links only, one per unit); email forwarding to one shared address, routed by the host's Airbnb email.
- Guest ID scans stay as the host's own data. Hosts can delete their account themselves with a typed confirmation.
- **Emails:** verification and welcome; trial-ending and payment reminders.
- **Support:** WhatsApp button and a Help page. **Legal:** placeholder Terms and Privacy accepted at sign-up, to be reviewed by the owner.
- **Owner's admin tools:** hosts list (plan, status, trial end), extend trial or comp a plan, mark a manual payment received, view-as-host (read-only).
- **Launch:** landing page at the root URL, then a free beta with 3–10 friendly hosts before billing goes on.

Launch scope

Sign-up, trial, units, iCal sync, calendar, bookings, manual plan activation. Then: payment gateway, email forwarding, expenses and stats, annual billing.

Build phases

1. **Data model and isolation.** Plans and subscriptions tables, account type on clients, unit limit check. Review every access rule and page that relies on session scope, because strangers now share these tables.
2. **Sign-up and onboarding.** Public sign-up, email verification, terms acceptance, guided checklist (add unit, paste iCal link, first booking).
3. **Host mode screens.** Hide Money and staff tools, booking form without the split card, Help page, WhatsApp.
4. **Sync safeguards.** iCal link allow-list, no internal addresses, sync skips paused hosts.
5. **Admin: Hosts.** List, extend trial, comp, mark payment received, view-as-host.
6. **Lifecycle.** Trial to read-only to paused, reminder emails, over-limit blocking, account deletion and export.
7. **Landing and legal pages.** Pricing, Sign up, placeholder Terms and Privacy.
8. **Beta** with 3–10 hosts, fix issues, then switch billing on.
9. **Later:** gateway webhook, host email forwarding, expenses and stats parity, annual billing, Pro audit-request button.

Open items

- Choose a gateway (Safepay, PayFast, etc.) and confirm it supports recurring billing for a Pakistan business.
- Set Growth and Pro prices.
- Have Terms and Privacy text reviewed.
- Supabase plan is fine under 50 hosts; revisit before growth.
- A payment webhook is a route handler, so it needs a documented exception to the "no route handlers" rule.